

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
 Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

NOTE: This rhyme-letter from a missionary in the Philippines, Edw'd F. Casey to his Brother Maurice Joachim in Yonkers, N. Y. has been referred to as a cure for the blues; - - at once humorous and poetic, ascetic and practical. In a way, reckoned-on as: "To be the Priest of the Family" before he was born, the latter had given promise from early childhood of every requirement for such an ideal setup. He was talented at once and modest. He loved his catechism and his prayers and everything pertaining to service of God and neighbor. Even the neighboring children were in on his secret without his seeming to know it.

Alas! however, as dear Father was wont to repeat, the proverb: "Man proposes-God disposes." Poor, dear Maurice's health failed and he came home from the Seminary a family disappointment and worse than that in his own words: "a misfit, a personal failure - - a sadly misfit and personal failure." Ah! It was about that time that silver began to tell its story in Mother's hair and Father's sighs would bring a gentle Soliloquy: "If I had to start life over again, I'd be a priest." Winters and summers slipped away. Years and decads rolled by. Never to be discouraged under such circumstances would surely be more than human. But this was by no means the first knock he had met, and God, if "those whom God loves He tries," it was far from being the last he was to wether. It did not take too long to adjust himself to what seemed next best. He would promote vocations in others at least and in this way possibly influence someone to take his place at the Altar, in the confessional, on the missions.

Second of ten brothers in a family of 16, he had started afore-said E'd. F. to the Seminary and after twenty years vacation had served at the First Mass of another younger brother whom also he had helped.